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On the Promulgation of the Cybercrime Law

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> ***Abrogates:***
> ***Oman Sultani Decree No. 12/2011 dated 06/02/2011***

We, Haitham bin Tariq, Sultan of Oman,

After perusal of the Basic Statute of the State; and

The Cybercrime Law promulgated by Oman Sultani Decree No. 12/2011;

Upon presentation to the Council of Oman; and

Based on the public interest requirements,

Have decreed as follows:

Article 1

The provisions of the attached Cybercrime Law shall come into force.

Article 2

The aforementioned Cybercrime Law shall be abrogated, as shall be any provision contrary to the attached Law or in conflict with its provisions.

Article 3

This Decree shall be published in the Official Gazette, and it shall come into force from the day following the date of its publication.

Issued on: 15 Dhi Al-Hijjah 1447 H.

Corresponding to: 1 June 2026

Haitham bin Tariq

Sultan of Oman

This Sultani Decree was published in Official Gazette, Issue No. (1651) dated 07/06/2026, p. 5.

The Cybercrime Law

Chapter 1 - Definitions and General Provisions

Article 1

In application of the provisions of this Law, the following terms and expressions shall have the meaning assigned against each, unless the context requires otherwise:

1. Ministry:

   The Ministry of Transport, Communications and Information Technology.

2. Minister:

   The Minister of Transport, Communications and Information Technology.

3. Electronic Data or Information:

   Anything that can be created, stored, processed or transferred by Means of Information Technology, in any form such as written text, images, sounds, symbols, signs, numbers, codes or letters.

4. Government Electronic Data or Information:

   Electronic Data or Information relating to the units of the Administrative Apparatus of the State and other public legal persons, as well as companies in which the Government holds more than forty percent (40%) of their capital, and which is available through any Means of Information Technology or Information System.

5. Means of Information Technology:

   An electronic tool or device used to process Electronic Data or Information and perform logical and arithmetic operations based on stored commands and instructions, such as computers, communication devices, software, software commands or other electronic tools or devices.

6. Electronic Data or Information Processing:

   An operation or set of operations performed on Electronic Data or Information, including its collection, analysis, storage, transfer, sending, receipt or any other operation.

7. Information System:

A set of computer programmes, applications, Social Media Platforms or Artificial Intelligence Systems designed for the creation, processing and management of Electronic Data or Information interconnected through an information network.

8. Artificial Intelligence:

   A field of computer science that focuses on developing technologies, algorithms and systems that analyse data, learn from such data and simulate certain human cognitive abilities such as vision, language understanding, problem-solving and decision-making. These systems may also perform specific tasks based on pattern analysis and inference of solutions from available data.

9. Artificial Intelligence Systems:

   Computer programmes or devices that use Artificial Intelligence to perform specific tasks.

10. Social Media Platforms:

    An electronic space that enables the user to create an account, page, group, channel or the like, through which the user publishes, sends or receives images or video or audio clips and recordings through comments, written text, numbers, symbols or any other form of interaction.

11. Website:

    A virtual space with a specific address on the information network for providing data, information or electronic services.

12. Digital Evidence:

    Any Electronic Data or Information having evidentiary value that is stored, transferred or extracted from an Information System or Means of Information Technology.

13. Electronic Payment Instrument:

    A tool that enables a person to obtain funds, goods or services, or to make payments and transfer funds by Means of Information Technology, such as smart cards or electronic stored-value cards.

Article 2

The provisions of this Law shall apply to the crimes stipulated herein, even if committed wholly or partially outside the Sultanate of Oman, where such crimes prejudice its interests or persons, or where the criminal result materialises in the Sultanate of Oman, or was intended to materialise therein, even if it has not actually materialised.

Article 3

The employees who are designated by a decision issued by the competent authority in agreement with the Minister shall have judicial enforcement capacity in the application of the provisions of this Law.

Article 4

Without prejudice to the competencies of the Electronic Defence Centre, the Ministry may, in coordination with the competent authorities, where sufficient grounds exist indicating the occurrence of a cybercrime, obtain Electronic Data or Information from counterpart entities and other government authorities and non-governmental entities inside and outside the Sultanate of Oman, pursuant to a judicial order issued by the Public Prosecution or the competent court, as the case may be.

Chapter 2 - Attacks on Electronic Data or Information and Information Systems

Article 5

Whoever intentionally and unlawfully accesses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology or part thereof, exceeds authorised access thereto or remains therein after becoming aware of that, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one month and not exceeding six (6) months, and by a fine of not less than one hundred (100) Omani rials and not more than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

If such act results in the deletion, alteration, modification, addition, distortion, damage, copying, destruction, slowing, publication, republication, disclosure, blocking or encryption of Electronic Data or Information stored in the Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology, or results in the destruction of such Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology, or causes harm to users or beneficiaries, or results in the appropriation of the address or domain name of the Website, the penalty shall be imprisonment for a term of not less than six (6) months and not exceeding one year, and a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties. If the Electronic Data or Information stipulated in the second paragraph of this Article is of a personal nature, the penalty shall be imprisonment for a term of not less than one year and not exceeding three (3) years, and a fine of not less than two thousand (2,000) Omani rials and not more than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

The perpetrator shall be exempt from punishment if they are a parent, guardian, custodian, trustee or caregiver and have committed the act to protect the interests of a person who is incapacitated or lacks capacity.

Article 6

Whoever intentionally and unlawfully obtains a PIN, code, password or any other means of access to an Information System, Website or Means of Information Technology, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one month and not exceeding one year, and by a fine of not less than five hundred (500) Omani rials and not more than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

The perpetrator shall be exempt from punishment if they are a parent, guardian, custodian, trustee or caregiver and have committed the act to protect the interests of a person who is incapacitated or lacks capacity.

Article 7

Whoever commits one of the crimes stipulated in Article (5) of this Law during or in connection with the performance of their duties, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one year and not exceeding three (3) years and a fine of not less than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials and not more than seven thousand (7,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties. Termination of service or loss of capacity shall not preclude the application of the provisions of this Article.

Article 8

Whoever intentionally and unlawfully obtains, alters, modifies, blocks, encrypts, deletes, destroys or discloses Electronic Data or Information through an Information System or Means of Information Technology, where such data or information relates to a medical examination, diagnosis or record or to the dispensing of medications or medical care, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one month and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials and not more than ten thousand (10,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

Article 9

Whoever intentionally and unlawfully uses an Information System or Means of Information Technology to view or obtain Electronic Data or Information, with intent to intercept, track, disrupt, store, copy, record, alter content, modify routes, reroute, interrupt or suspend transmission or reception or reduce its efficiency, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than six (6) months and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

Article 10

Whoever intentionally and unlawfully accesses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology with intent to obtain unauthorised Government Electronic Data or Information, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one year and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

The penalty shall be imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) years and not exceeding seven (7) years, and a fine of not less than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials and not more than ten thousand (10,000) Omani rials if such act results in the deletion, alteration, modification, blocking, encryption, distortion, removal, damage, copying, destruction, slowing, publication or republication of the Electronic Data or Information, or the appropriation of the address or domain name of the Website.

Electronic Data or Information of banks and financial institutions shall be deemed Government Electronic Data or Information for the application of this Article.

Article 11

Whoever commits one of the crimes stipulated in Article (10) of this Law during or in connection with the performance of their duties shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) years and not exceeding ten (10) years, and by a fine of not less than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials and not more than fifteen thousand (15,000) Omani rials. Termination of service or loss of capacity shall not preclude the application of the provisions of this Article.

Chapter 3 - Misuse of Means of Information Technology

Article 12

Whoever possesses, acquires, brings in, sells, makes available, manufactures, produces, imports, exports or trades in any form, any devices, equipment, tools or programmes designed, developed or modified or passwords, codes, symbols or any similar data, with intent to use any of them in perpetrating or facilitating the perpetration of any of the crimes stipulated in this Law, or to conceal their traces or Digital Evidence, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than six (6) months and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials and not more than fifteen thousand (15,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

Article 13

Any civil servant who intentionally causes the exposure of any Information System or Website to any of the crimes stipulated in this Law by failing to take the necessary measures and precautions issued by the Ministry or any competent authority, shall be

punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one year and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

Chapter 4 - Refusal to Provide or Tampering with Evidence

Article 14

Whoever conceals or refuses to provide secret codes for Means of Information Technology used in perpetrating or facilitating the perpetration of any of the crimes stipulated in this Law to law enforcement officers, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than six (6) months and not exceeding one year, and by a fine of not less than five hundred (500) Omani rials and not more than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

Article 15

Any person responsible for Digital Evidence who conceals or refuses to provide such evidence to law enforcement officers, or tampers with such evidence, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than six (6) months and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

Chapter 5 - Forgery and Information Fraud

Article 16

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to impersonate a physical or legal person, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one month and not exceeding one year, and by a fine of not less than five hundred (500) Omani rials and not more than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials, or by either of these two penalties.

Article 17

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to obtain for themselves or for others an unlawful benefit from third parties by resorting to fraudulent means, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one year and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties. The penalty shall be doubled if the fraud is committed against a person who is incapacitated or lacks capacity, or in case there are multiple victims.

Article 18

Whoever uses an Information System or Means of Information Technology to forge Electronic Data or Information by fabrication, addition, deletion, replacement or by any other means, with intent to use it in an Information System or Website to achieve unlawful benefit for themselves or for others or to cause harm to others, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one year and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties. The penalty shall be imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) years and not exceeding seven (7) years, and a fine of not less than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials and not more than twenty thousand (20,000) Omani rials if such data or information is of a governmental nature.

Whoever uses forged Electronic Data or Information despite being aware that it is forged shall be subjected to the same penalties provided for in the first and second paragraphs of this Article.

Chapter 6 - Content-Related Offences

Section 1 - Offences Affecting the State

Article 19

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to send, publish or transmit Electronic Data or Information without authorisation from the Public Prosecution or the competent court - as the case may be - shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one month and not exceeding two (2) years, and by a fine of not less than one hundred (100) Omani rials and not more than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials, or by either of these two penalties, where such data or information relates to the following:

1. Ongoing investigations or publication of any of their documents.
2. News regarding cases that are being heard or that have been heard before the court.
3. Names or photos of the parties to a case or the convicted parties.

Article 20

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to produce, make available, store, transmit, send, publish or republish any of the following shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one month and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials, or by either of these two penalties:

1. Anything likely to involve a breach of public order or public morals.
2. Rumours or misleading information, whether directly or indirectly.

The penalty shall be imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) years and not exceeding ten (10) years, and by a fine of not less than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials and not more than ten thousand (10,000) Omani rials, where the intent is to incite sedition, hatred, racism, sectarianism, division or self-harm.

Article 21

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to incite or call for gatherings, strikes, sit-ins or marches in other than the licensed cases, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) months and not exceeding one year, and a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials.

Article 22

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to trade in weapons set out in List No. (1) annexed to the Weapons and Ammunition Law, or in the tools provided for in Clause (b) under Article (3) of the same law, or to facilitate dealings therein, unless legally licensed to do so, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one month and not exceeding one year, and by a fine of not less than one hundred (100) Omani rials and not more than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

The penalty shall be imprisonment for a term of not less than one year and not exceeding three (3) years, and a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials, or either of these penalties, where the intent is to trade in weapons set out in List No. (2) annexed to the same law. The penalty shall be imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) years and not exceeding five (5) years, and a fine of not less than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials and not more than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials, where the intent is to trade in weapons set out in List No. (3) annexed to the same law or their ammunition.

The penalty shall be imprisonment for a term of not less than five (5) years and not exceeding fifteen (15) years, and a fine of not less than ten thousand (10,000) Omani rials and not more than one hundred thousand (100,000) Omani rials, where the intent is to trade in weapons stipulated in Clause (a) under Article (3) of the same law or their essential parts or ammunition.

Article 23

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to publish false or malicious news, statements or rumours, or to disseminate inflammatory propaganda, with intent to undermine the reputation, standing or prestige of the State or one of its authorities or institutions, undermine confidence in its financial markets or its economic and financial standing, or directly or indirectly affect its security, social or health stability, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) months and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than two thousand (2,000) Omani rials and not more than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials.

Article 24

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to show contempt for the currency, flag, emblem or national anthem of the Sultanate of Oman, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) months and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than two thousand (2,000) Omani rials and not more than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials.

Article 25

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to publish the movements, systems or internal regulations of military or security agencies, where such publication is likely to prejudice work interests, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) months and not more than three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than two thousand (2,000) Omani rials and not more than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

The penalty shall be imprisonment for a term of not less than five (5) years and not exceeding fifteen (15) years, and a fine of not less than ten thousand (10,000) Omani rials and not more than one hundred thousand (100,000) Omani rials, or either of these penalties, if the act stipulated in the first paragraph of this Article is committed during a state of emergency, wartime, disasters or epidemics.

Article 26

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to publicly disparage the head of a foreign State or the head of its government, or a representative of a foreign State accredited to the Sultanate of Oman, or insult any of them personally, or publish anything likely to prejudice the foreign relations or interests of the Sultanate of Oman, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than six (6) months and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than five thousand (5,000) Omani Rials, or by either of these penalties.

Article 27

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to publicly undermine the respect due to the judicial authority in a manner that casts doubt on its integrity or its compliance with the provisions of the Law, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one year and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

Article 28

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to trade in antiquities, minerals, meteorites or works of art other than in the cases authorised by law, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one year and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than ten thousand (10,000) Omani rials and not more than one hundred thousand (100,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

Article 29

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to trade in weapons, ammunition or explosives stipulated under the Weapons, Ammunition and Explosives Law relating to military and security agencies, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) years and not exceeding five (5) years, and by a fine of not less than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials and not more than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

Article 30

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means or Information Technology to provide false or misleading information to individuals, organisations, institutions, bodies or any other entities, where such information is likely to prejudice the interests of the State or undermine its reputation, prestige or standing, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) months and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than two thousand (2,000) Omani rials and not more than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials.

The penalty shall be imprisonment for a term of not less than five (5) years and not exceeding fifteen (15) years, and a fine of not less than ten thousand (10,000) Omani rials and not more than one hundred thousand (100,000) Omani rials, if the act stipulated in the first paragraph of this Article is committed during a state of emergency, wartime, disasters or epidemics.

Article 31

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to call for, incite or promote the hindering of the provisions of the Basic Statute of the State, laws in force, Sultani decrees or orders, judicial rulings or orders issued by a judicial body, or to prevent the units of the Administrative Apparatus of the State or other public legal persons from discharging their functions, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) years and not exceeding ten (10) years, and by a fine of not less than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials and not more than ten thousand (10,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

Article 32

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to challenge the rights or authority of the Sultan, or to insult the Sultan personally, or to disparage the Sultan's wife, Crown Prince or children or insult them personally, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) years and not exceeding ten (10) years, and by a fine of not less than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials and not more than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials.

Article 33

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology with intent to commit one of the money laundering crimes stipulated in the Anti-Money Laundering and Counter-Terrorism Financing Law shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than five (5) years and not exceeding ten (10) years, and by a fine of not less than fifty thousand (50,000) Omani rials and not exceeding the value of the funds that are the subject of the crime.

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology with intent to commit the crime of terrorism financing stipulated in the Anti-Money Laundering and Counter-Terrorism Financing Law shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than seven (7) years and not exceeding fifteen (15) years, and by a fine of not less than fifty thousand (50,000) Omani rials and not exceeding the value of the funds collected or secured.

Article 34

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information technology to produce, prepare, make available, store, transmit, send, publish or republish the principles of a terrorist organisation, or anything that involves or promotes programmes, ideas or principles for terrorist purposes, or to publish methods of manufacturing explosives, weapons, tools, devices, means, media or other items used in terrorist operations, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than seven (7) years and not exceeding ten (10) years, and by a fine of not less than ten thousand (10,000) Omani rials and not more than fifty thousand (50,000) Omani rials.

Section 2 - Crimes Affecting the Family and Society

Article 35

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to call for or promote the collection of donations from the public without being licensed by the legally competent authority, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one month and not exceeding three (3) months, and by a fine of not less than three hundred (300) Omani rials and not more than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

Article 36

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology with intent to violate the sanctity of the private or family life of individuals by any of the following means shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) months and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties:

1. Eavesdropping on, intercepting, recording, transferring, transmitting or disclosing conversations, communications or audio or visual material.
2. Taking, transferring, revealing, copying or retaining images or video clips of others.
3. Publishing news, electronic images, photographs, audio or video clips, comments, data or information, even if true and accurate, with intent to cause harm to a person.
4. Taking and transferring or publishing images of injured persons, deceased persons or victims of accidents or disasters without authorisation or the consent of those concerned.
5. Tracking, monitoring, disclosing, transferring, revealing, copying or retaining the geolocation data of others.
6. Making any alteration to or processing audio or video clips or images of others, with intent to defame, insult or portray them in a manner likely to prejudice their honour or dignity.
7. Exploiting a child under the age of fifteen (15) years or domestic workers as negative media content, or publishing content that promotes violence or excessive fear among children.

Article 37

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to engage in begging or soliciting alms for the purpose of obtaining a benefit, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) months and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

The penalty provided for in the preceding paragraph shall be doubled if the perpetrator uses a child or an incapacitated person with the intention of begging.

Whoever proves that they were acting out of necessity, or were incapable of earning a livelihood and had no other source of income shall be exempted from the penalty.

Article 38

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology with intent to promote or sell unlicensed medicines, substances or herbal products or medicines shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) months and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials and not more than one hundred thousand (100,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

The penalty provided for in the preceding paragraph shall be doubled if the medicines, substances or herbal products or medicines are adulterated, counterfeit or expired.

Article 39

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to engage in an act of sorcery, witchcraft, charlatanism or superstition, whether real or deceptive, for consideration or free of charge, with intent to exploit, benefit or harm other, or under the pretence thereof, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one year and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than three hundred (300) Omani rials and not more than one thousand

(1,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties. The following shall constitute acts of sorcery, witchcraft, charlatanism or superstition:

1. Performing acts, uttering words or using methods or means that are not permissible or not reasonably acceptable to influence the body, spirit, mind or will of others, directly or indirectly, whether actually or imaginatively.
2. Deceiving the sight of people or controlling their senses or hearts by any means to cause them to perceive things contrary to reality, with intent to exploit them or influence their beliefs or minds.

In all cases, the confiscation of the objects and tools used in the perpetration of the crime shall be ordered.

Article 40

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to threaten or blackmail a person to compel that person to perform or refrain from performing an act, even if such act is lawful shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one year and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials.

The penalty shall be imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) years and not exceeding ten (10) years, and by a fine of not less than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials and not more than ten thousand (10,000) Omani rials, if the threat or blackmail involves the perpetration of a felony or engaging in acts prejudicial to honour or dignity.

Article 41

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to incite, entice or lure a male or female to engage in debauchery or prostitution, or assists others in doing so, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) years and not exceeding seven (7) years, and by a fine of not less than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials and not more than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials.

Article 42

The penalty shall be imprisonment for a term of not less than five (5) years and not exceeding ten (10) years, and by a fine of not less than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials and not more than ten thousand (10,000) Omani rials, if the victim under Articles (40) and (41) of this Law is a child or an incapacitated person.

Article 43

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to engage in the trafficking of human organs, or to facilitate dealings therein, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) years and not exceeding ten (10) years, and by a fine of not less than twenty-five thousand (25,000) Omani rials and not more than one hundred and fifty thousand (150,000) Omani rials.

Article 44

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to commit one of the following acts shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than five (5) years and not exceeding ten (10) years, and by a fine of not less than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials and not more than ten thousand (10,000) Omani rials:

1. Offending or insulting the Divine Entity.
2. Insulting or distorting the Holy Qur'an.
3. Insulting Islam or one of its rites, or insulting one of the religions.
4. Offending or insulting one of the Prophets.

Article 45

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to engage in human trafficking, or to facilitate dealings therein, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than ten (10) years and not exceeding fifteen (15) years, and by a fine of not less than twenty thousand (20,000) Omani rials and not more than one hundred and fifty thousand (150,000) Omani rials.

Article 46

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology with intent to engage in the trafficking of or to promote narcotic drugs or psychotropic substances listed in Schedules No. (1), (2), (3) and (4) of Group (1), and Schedule No. (1) of Group (2) annexed to the Law on Combating Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances, or the substances used in their manufacture, shall be punished by execution or life imprisonment, and by a fine of not less than fifty thousand (50,000) Omani rials and not more than one hundred thousand (100,000) Omani rials.

The penalty shall be imprisonment for a term of not less than ten (10) years and not exceeding fifteen (15) years, and a fine of not less than ten thousand (10,000) Omani rials and not more than fifteen thousand (15,000) Omani rials, where the intent is to publish methods of using such drugs or substances or to facilitate dealings therein other than in the cases authorised by law.

Section 3 - Pornography and Gambling Games

Article 47

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology in gambling games shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one month and not exceeding six (6) months, and by a fine of not less than one hundred (100) Omani rials and not more than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

Article 48

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to create, produce, make available, send, transmit, publish or republish pornographic material, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one year and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

The penalty shall be imprisonment for a term of not less than five (5) years and not exceeding fifteen (15) years, and by a fine of not less than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials and not more than fifteen thousand (15,000) Omani rials, if the pornographic content involves a child or an incapacitated person, or if the criminal act is directed at them. The same penalty shall apply to whomever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to possess child pornography material.

Section 4 - Insult and Defamation

Article 49

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to publicly insult others in a manner that prejudices their honour or dignity, diminishes their standing, or is insulting to them, or publicly defames others by attributing to them a fact or an incident likely to expose them to contempt, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than three (3) months and not exceeding one year, and by a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

The penalty shall be doubled if the insult or defamation is directed at a civil servant by reason of their performance of their job or their affiliation thereto.

Article 50

If the insult or defamation stipulated in Article (49) of this Law is not committed publicly, the punishment shall be imprisonment for a term of not less than one month and not exceeding six (6) months, and by a fine of not less than one hundred (100) Omani rials and not more than five hundred (500) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

Section 5 - Crimes Affecting Property Rights

Article 51

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to infringe upon a legally protected right of an author, a neighbouring rights holder or an industrial property right holder, in any of the forms of infringement provided for by law, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than six (6) months and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials and not more than fifteen thousand (15,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

Section 6 - Unauthorised Use of Electronic Payment Instrument

Article 52

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to unlawfully obtain or appropriate Electronic Payment Instrument data with intent to provide it to others or to facilitate access thereto, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one year and not exceeding two (2) years, and by a fine of not less than one thousand (1,000) Omani rials and not more than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

Article 53

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to obtain or appropriate Electronic Payment Instrument data with intent to unlawfully obtain services provided by the Electronic Payment Instrument, whether for themselves or for others, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one year and not exceeding three (3)

years, and by a fine of not less than three thousand (3,000) Omani rials and not more than ten thousand (10,000) Omani rials, or by either of these penalties.

Article 54

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to counterfeit an Electronic Payment Instrument shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than one year and not exceeding three (3) years, and by a fine of not less than five thousand (5,000) Omani rials and not more than ten thousand (10,000) Omani rials.

Chapter 8 - Organised Crimes

Article 55

Whoever uses a Website, Information System or Means of Information Technology to form an organised criminal group, contribute to its formation, participate in its activities, act for its account or cooperate with it, with intent to commit any of the crimes stipulated in this Law, shall be punished by imprisonment for a term of not less than five (5) years and not exceeding ten (10) years, and by a fine of not less than one hundred thousand (100,000) Omani rials and not more than five hundred thousand (500,000) Omani rials.

Chapter 9 - Final Provisions

Article 56

Prosecution for the crimes stipulated in Articles (16), (36) excluding Clause (7) thereof, (49) and the first paragraph of Article (38) of this Law shall be initiated upon a complaint by the victim or their private or legal representative.

Article 57

Without prejudice to the criminal liability of physical persons, a legal person shall be punishable by a fine equal to double the maximum fine prescribed by law for the crime if the crime was committed in its name or for its account by its chairman, a member of its board of directors, its manager or any other officer acting in that capacity, or with its approval, or due to its concealment or gross negligence.

Article 58

An attempt to commit any of the crimes stipulated in this Law shall be punishable by half the maximum penalty prescribed by law for the crime.

Article 59

The same penalty prescribed for the perpetrator of any of the crimes stipulated in this Law shall apply to whomever incites, assists or agrees with others to commit such crimes. If the criminal result does not materialise, the perpetrator shall be punished by a penalty not exceeding half the maximum penalty prescribed by law for the crime.

Article 60

Without prejudice to the rights of bona fide third parties, the competent court may, in all cases, order the following:

1. Confiscation of all devices, tools, programmes and other objects used in the perpetration of any of the crimes stipulated in this Law, as well as the proceeds thereof.
2. Closure of the Information System, Website or premises in which any of the crimes stipulated in this Law were committed or attempts thereof were made. Such closure shall be permanent or temporary for a period determined by the court in light of the circumstances and facts of the crime.

Article 61

Whoever refrains from or obstructs the execution of a court judgment issued pursuant to Article (60) of this Law shall be punished by half the penalty imposed on the convicted party.

Article 62

Any perpetrator or accomplice who comes forward to the competent authorities to report information concerning a crime committed in violation of the provisions of this Law before it is discovered shall be exempt from punishment. If such information is provided after the crime has been discovered, the court may exempt that person from punishment, provided that such disclosure results in the arrest of the remaining perpetrators.